

Writing Clean and Scalable PHP Applications

Writing modern, clean and scalable PHP applications doesn't require the use of a framework. Though there are many frameworks available, many a time, these are unnecessary. The first article in this series on PHP guides readers on how to incorporate clean PHP into their next Web project.



PHP is a popular server side scripting language that powers a significant chunk of the World Wide Web. The early 2000s saw high adoption of the language at major websites; however, in subsequent years, there has been a steady decline in its use as other technologies have come along.

Often, PHP gets the rap because of how it was initially designed. This is because of the developers rather than the language itself. PHP has a relatively

gradual learning curve, and so it's easier for new developers to get started with it.

The language has gone through significant improvements over the years. A major leap was PHP 7.0 which came with a faster engine and paved the way for developers to build modern Web applications with ease.

Do note that in this article, I greatly emphasise writing 'clean' code, a term that doesn't have a formal definition, but most will agree that it possesses the following qualities:

- Readability
- Separation of concerns
- Loose coupling
- High cohesion
- Well structured

Now that we are clear about what we want to accomplish, let's dive into it. This article assumes that you are using PHP 7+.

Dependency management

Having worked on PHP for quite some time now, it's not surprising to find PHP